

Brandon Pastuszek

SENIOR PRODUCT LEADER · NEWS, VIDEO & CONSUMER MEDIA

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- BREAKING NEWS
- ▶ VIDEO & VOD
- 📰 EDITORIAL PRODUCTS
- ✂️ AUDIENCE ENGAGEMENT
- ⚡ CURRENT EVENTS

◆ EDUCATION

RIT

B.S. Software Engineering

Minors in Computer Science and Behavioral Economics

Rochester Institute of Technology
Rochester, NY

◆ SKILLS

Product

Product Vision, Audience Discovery, Roadmaps, Video & Content Experiences, Requirements, Experimentation, Engagement Metrics, Launch Readiness, Product Analytics

Web

TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, Angular, Node, Express, Restify, SCSS, LESS, SASS, CSS, NPM, Grunt, Gulp, Webpack

Mobile

iOS, tvOS, Swift, Objective-C, Flutter

Backend

Java, Kotlin, Spring Boot, CXF, Lombok, Aspect-Oriented Programming

Database

SQL-based (MS SQL, MySQL, MariaDB), MongoDB, DynamoDB, Redis

Infrastructure

AWS, Google Cloud Platform (GCP), Microsoft Azure, Kafka, Kinesis

Platforms & Delivery

Braze, Adobe Journey Optimizer, Splunk, Jira/Confluence, Agile, CI/CD, Docker, GitHub, GitLab, Jenkins, Harness

Leadership

Executive Communication, Stakeholder Alignment, Cross-functional Leadership, Product Engineering, Mentoring, International Collaboration

◆ NEWS PRODUCT FIT

Audience-First Builder

Lead from audience needs and product strategy through design, delivery, launch, measurement, and iteration across mobile, web, and connected TV.

News & Current Events

Daily, all-day news consumer with a deep interest in politics, campaigns, breaking stories, and how audiences discover and understand events.

Campaign Perspective

Brings hands-on campaign experience and participates in current-events prediction markets, sharpening instincts for news cycles, audience attention, and fast-moving narratives.

Editorial Partnership

Translate complex mobile, web, backend, data, messaging, and connected-device constraints into clear decisions with product, design, engineering, analytics, editorial, and business partners.

◆ RECOGNITION

- “*Goes above and beyond his assigned tasks*”
- “*Proactive approach*”
- “*Attention to detail and commitment*”
- “*Always available*”

More at brandonpastuszek.github.io

TOP STORY

Audience-obsessed product and engineering leader with 15+ years delivering high-scale consumer experiences across Disney Parks and entertainment. News junkie, former campaign worker, and active participant in current-events prediction markets who follows breaking news throughout the day and understands the urgency, trust, and usability that news products demand. Brings proven mobile, web, tvOS, messaging, analytics, and platform depth to shape strategy, align cross-functional teams, and launch reliable experiences at global scale.

◆ EXPERIENCE



Self-Employed / Freelance

Orlando, FL

Senior Product Engineer

May 2026–Present

- Own the full product lifecycle across audience discovery, product strategy, requirements, prioritization, design, full-stack implementation, launch, production monitoring, and measurable iteration.
- Use rapid prototyping, AI-assisted development, and qualitative feedback to test consumer product concepts, reduce delivery time, and make tradeoffs tangible for stakeholders.
- Translate business needs into actionable plans and executive-ready product and technical presentations for organizational leaders.



Disney Experiences

Orlando, FL

Lead Software Engineer

Jun 2022–May 2026

Senior Software Engineer

May 2018–Jun 2022

Lightning Lane & Guest Service

- Led product and technical integration of a Cast-facing Lightning Lane booking flow with Hong Kong Disneyland point-of-sale hardware, aligning operations, software, and device constraints to accelerate transactions and increase sales.
- Partnered with Hong Kong teams to adapt and launch the Cast-facing Guest Service Suite, coordinating data configuration, requirements, integration testing, and operational scenarios; unified Guest and entitlement triage to reduce service time.
- Defined and delivered configurable Lightning Lane entitlements for ticket offers, enabling flexible promotion strategies designed to drive ticket conversion and incremental revenue.

Virtual Queue

- Helped define and build Virtual Queue from day one across mobile, web, and backend, launching in Walt Disney World and Disneyland apps; the product saves Guests thousands of cumulative years in physical lines annually and increased nearby food-and-beverage sales.
- Led cross-platform strategy and migration of Virtual Queue from native iOS/Android to Flutter and web; served as liaison between Disney and Google and aligned mobile, web, and backend teams around a shared product architecture.
- Set up and configured Braze, D-Scribe CMS for Virtual Queue. Regularly updated.

Resort & Passholder Experiences

- Developed ability to limit Guests from using Direct-to-Room functionality. This prevented fraud from some Guests using Vacation Club points for other Guests. When limited, the system would notify the Guest they should check-in at the front desk. Worked web and backend.
- Developed Annual Passholder Gift Card Promotion Fulfillment. As a special offer, purchasing or renewing an annual pass would also give the Guest a certain gift card amount. This encouraged more annual pass renewals and additional spending at Parks, dining, merchandise locations, and Resorts. Worked web and backend.

Guest Messaging

- Directed product and integration planning for migration from Braze to Adobe Journey Optimizer, evaluating APIs and prototyping a Guest messaging experience that expanded push notifications into an in-app notification center and enabled post-click journey measurement.

Platform & Engineering Leadership

- Established product-health monitoring and operational playbooks in Splunk, enabling teams to identify and self-diagnose dependency failures before customer reports—experience directly relevant to fast, reliable news and video products.
- Integrated Claude, Cursor, GitHub Copilot into engineering workflows for architecture, debugging, modernization, and delivery acceleration.
- Led cross-functional delivery teams ranging from 1 to 15 contributors, influencing priorities and execution without relying on direct reporting authority.
- Communicated strategy, delivery status, risks, and outcomes through executive-ready presentations.



Disney | ABC Television Group

Burbank, CA

Senior Software Engineer

Oct 2017–May 2018

- Led a major redesign of the ABC iOS and tvOS apps, improving interface clarity and performance across consumer video experiences.
- Architected the app as a reusable white-label platform, accelerating onboarding for FX and National Geographic during the Fox acquisition and demonstrating scalable media-product thinking.
- Automated the GitLab-to-Jenkins-to-TestFlight release pipeline, increasing delivery consistency and launch readiness for App Store products.
- Served as technical lead for a nine-person team and partnered across product, design, engineering, and media stakeholders.
- Communicated strategy, delivery status, risks, and outcomes through executive-ready presentations.



Disney Parks & Resorts Digital

Orlando, FL

Senior Software Engineer

May 2015–Oct 2017

Software Engineer

Dec 2012–May 2015

Web Developer

May 2011–Dec 2012

- Created Cast-facing iOS tools for booking FastPasses and using mobile devices to augment physical readers at FastPass locations. Worked on mobile, backend.
- Led development of FastPass+ Simplification, a major creative and functional update that made it easier for Guests to select experiences at specific times. Worked on mobile, web, backend. Regularly presented to executives.
- Led Great Food Fast, Disney’s first digital food pre-order service. This allowed Guests to order on their mobile device and their order would be delivered to their table. Worked mobile, web, backend.
- Brought FastPass selection experiences to mobile and web for Shanghai Disney Resort, Disneyland Resort, and Walt Disney World. This allowed Guests to book attraction reservations on their phones and web without running around the Park to do so. This allowed Guests to sleep in morning-of a Park day, plan in advance, and reduce stress of trying to get on their must-do attractions. Worked on mobile, web, backend. Regularly presented to executives.
- Developed itinerary and Finder. This allowed Guests to see and modify their plans, as well as discover what is out there to experience and book. Worked web and backend.
- Communicated strategy, delivery status, risks, and outcomes through executive-ready presentations.



Trifecta Technologies

Allentown, PA

Software Engineer

Nov 2010–May 2011

- Continued my internship work remotely while finishing up my college degree at Rochester Institute of Technology. Developed and maintained Guest, Cast, and in-attraction MyMagic+ native mobile, web, backend prototypes. These were part of a \$1b+ project from Bob Iger to enhance Parks and Resorts through technology.



Walt Disney World Parks & Resorts

Orlando, FL

Information Technology Professional Intern

May 2010–Nov 2010

- Developed and maintained Guest, Cast, and in-attraction MyMagic+ native mobile, web, backend prototypes. These were part of a \$1b+ project from Bob Iger to enhance Parks and Resorts through technology. Regularly presented to executive teams up to 4 times a week.